

Sociology and Professional Ethics



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What is Socialization?

Socialization is the lifelong process through which

- individuals learn and internalize the values, norms, beliefs, customs, and behaviors of their society.
- It helps individuals develop a sense of identity and prepares them for social roles.
- Socialization occurs through interactions with family, peers, educational institutions, media, and other societal influences.

Scholarly Definitions of Socialization

Emile Durkheim (1858-1917) – Durkheim defined socialization as the process through which individuals become integrated into society by learning its norms and values, ensuring social cohesion and stability.

George Herbert Mead (1863-1931) – Mead viewed socialization as a process through which individuals develop a sense of self by interacting with others, particularly through symbolic communication and role-playing.

Talcott Parsons (1902-1979) – Parsons defined socialization as the mechanism by which cultural values and social norms are transmitted to individuals, ensuring the stability and continuity of society.

Anthony Giddens (b. 1938) – “Socialization as the process through which individuals develop awareness of social norms and values, influencing their behavior and participation in society”.

Agents of Socialization

Agents of socialization are the individuals, groups, and institutions that influence a person's social development and help them integrate into society. They include:

- **Family** – The primary agent of socialization, responsible for early childhood learning, emotional development, and the transmission of cultural values.
- **Peers** – Friends and social groups play a significant role in shaping attitudes, behaviors, and social skills, especially during adolescence.
- **Education System (Schools and Colleges)** – Schools teach discipline, cooperation, respect for authority, and societal values, alongside academic knowledge.
- **Mass Media** – Television, social media, newspapers, and the internet influence individuals' perceptions of reality, culture, and global events.



Workplace – As individuals enter the workforce, they learn professional ethics, corporate culture, and social responsibilities.

Government and Legal Systems – Laws, policies, and political structures shape individuals' civic responsibilities and legal awareness.

Functions of Socialization

1. **Primary Function**- Primary socialization occurs in early childhood. It is the first stage where children learn fundamental norms and values. Agents: Family, caregivers, close community members. It shapes personality, language, and emotional bonds.
2. **Secondary Function**-Secondary socialization occurs later in life through interactions beyond the family. Happens in schools, workplaces, peer groups, and mass media. Helps individuals integrate into different social roles and environments.

Cultural Transmission – Socialization helps-----

- Pass cultural norms, traditions, beliefs from one generation to another,
- Ensuring societal continuity.

Personality Development – It shapes an individual's character, emotions, attitudes, and overall personality through interactions with others.

Social Integration – Socialization fosters unity by helping individuals understand and adhere to shared social norms, reducing conflict.

Role Preparation – It prepares individuals for various social roles, such as being a student, worker, parent, or citizen, by teaching appropriate behaviors.

Social Control and Stability – Through internalized norms and values, socialization ensures conformity to societal expectations, promoting order and stability.

Identity Formation – It helps individuals develop a self-concept and social identity, influenced by culture, family, and experiences.

Change and Adaptation – Socialization enables individuals to adapt to new social environments, technological advancements, and cultural shifts.

Transmission of Knowledge and Skills – It equips individuals with the necessary knowledge, skills, and competencies to function effectively in society.

